TryHackMe Writeup: Search Skills

- **Platform:** TryHackMe
- **Room:** https://tryhackme.com/room/searchskillscS
- **Topic:** Cybersecurity research, OSINT, specialized search services, CVE lookups, technical documentation

1. Objective

The objective of this room is to learn how to find and evaluate cybersecurity information efficiently. It introduces specialized services and references for investigating internet-facing hosts, checking suspicious files, looking up vulnerabilities, reading Linux manual pages, and locating proof-of-concept code.

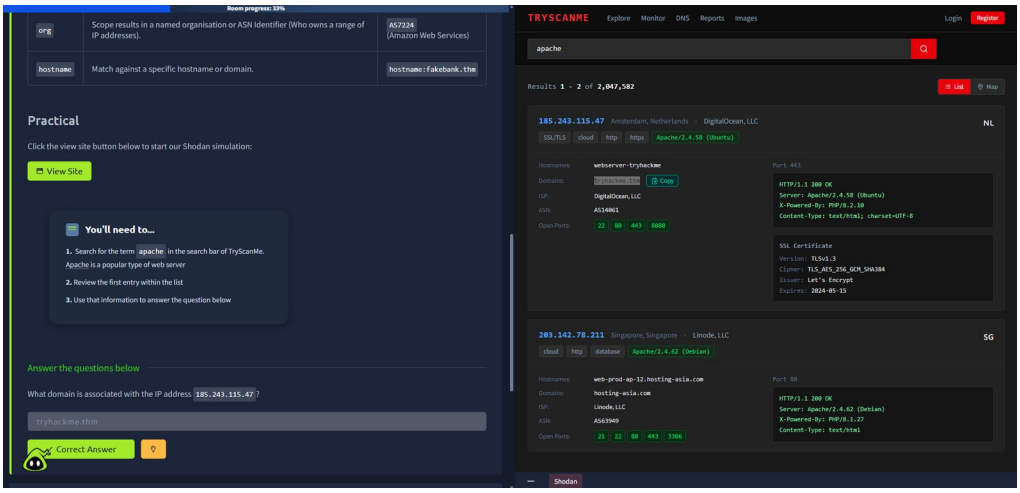
2. Tasks and Method

Task 1 - Introduction

Read the introductory material and review the purpose of research skills in cybersecurity.
Learning point: A good analyst needs to know both what to search for and which source is appropriate for the question.

Task 2 - Shodan / TryScanMe

1. Open the room's TryScanMe simulation.
2. Search for apache.
3. Inspect the host record for 185.243.115.47.
4. Read the domain/hostname information shown in that simulated record.

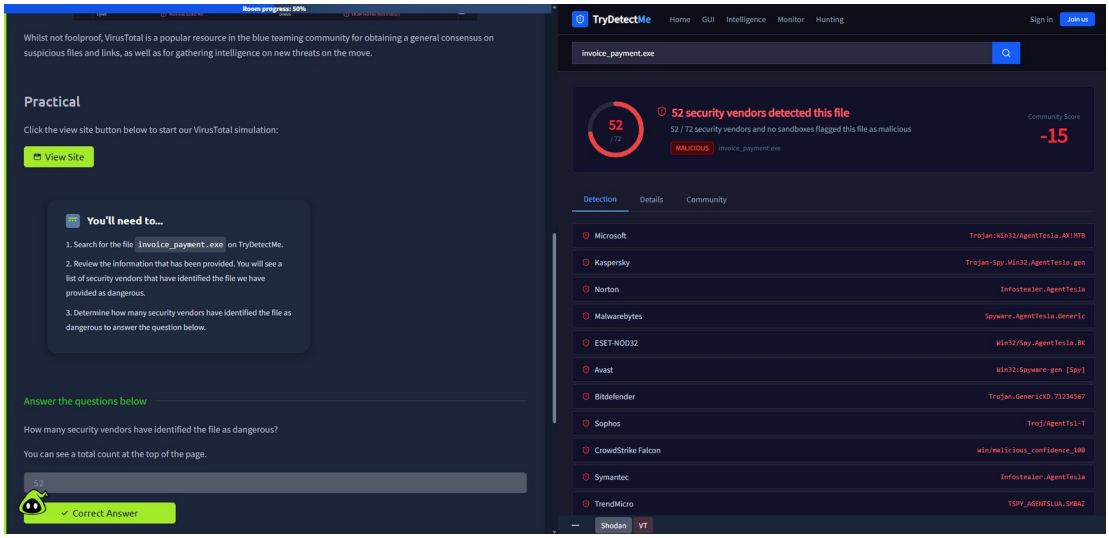


Answer recorded from a current-version walkthrough: tryhackme.thm

Learning point: Shodan-style search can help security teams understand what services and software versions are exposed. A public listing is not permission to connect to, scan, or exploit a host.

Task 3 - VirusTotal / TryDetectMe

1. Open the room's TryDetectMe simulation.
2. Search for invoice_payment.exe.
3. Review the total count of vendors that identified the file as dangerous.
4. Note that a detection count supports triage but is not, by itself, definitive proof that a file is malicious.

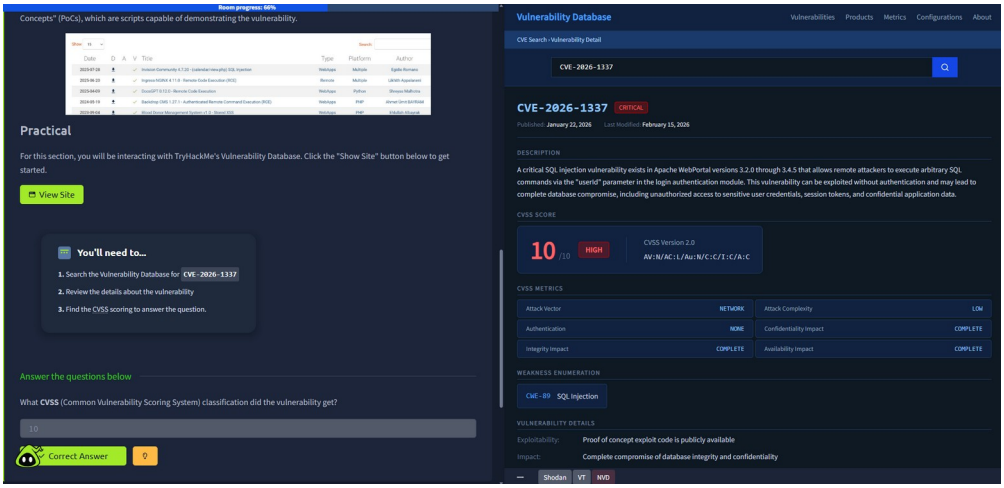


Answer recorded from a current-version walkthrough: 52 vendors

Learning point: Review vendor labels and file context as well as the total detection count. For real investigations, verify the file hash and report date.

Task 4 - Vulnerability Database / CVE

1. Open the room's vulnerability-database simulation.
2. Search for CVE-2026-1337.
3. Review the CVSS rating displayed for the fictional training vulnerability.



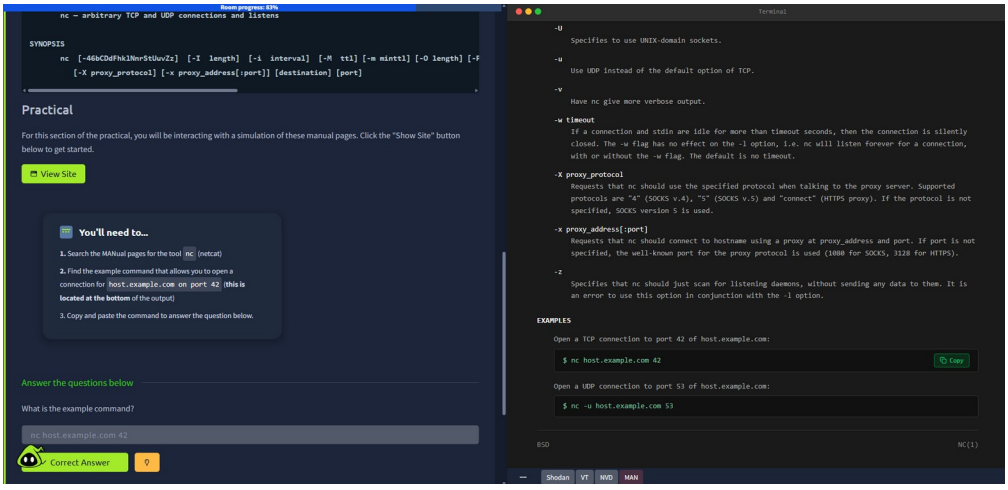
Answer recorded from a current version walkthrough: 10 (Critical; maximum CVSS score)

Important: CVE-2026-1337 is used as a fictional training item in this room; do not present it as a verified public vulnerability.

Learning point: A CVE identifier names a vulnerability record, while CVSS communicates severity. A score alone does not prove that a particular system is affected.

Task 5 - Technical Documentation / MAN

1. Open the simulated manual-page viewer.
2. Search for nc (netcat).
3. Read the example at the bottom showing how to connect to host.example.com on port 42.

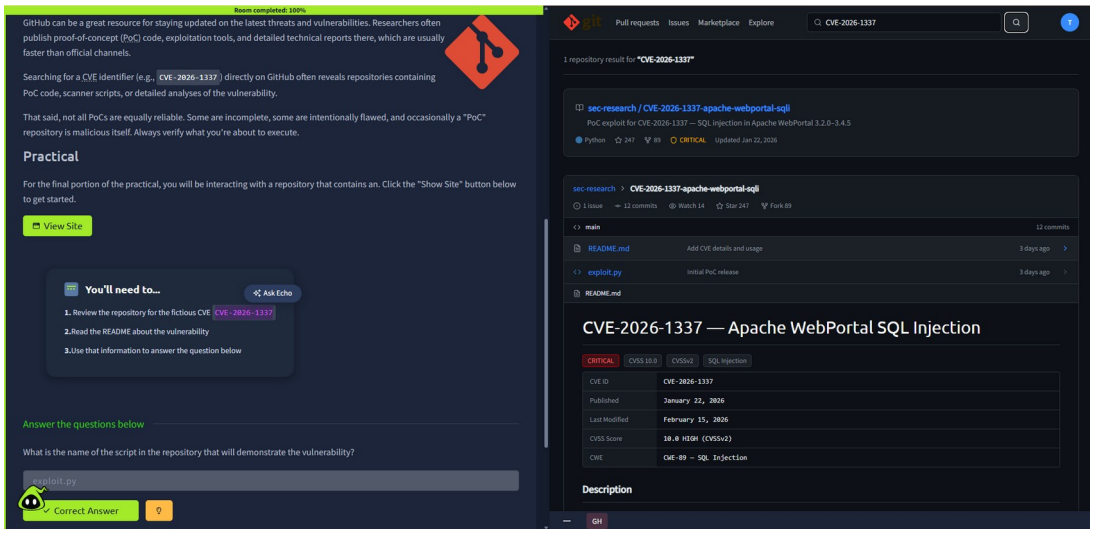


Answer: nc host.example.com 42

Learning point: Use manual pages (man <command>) and official documentation to verify syntax rather than relying only on third-party tutorials.

Task 6 - GitHub

1. Open the room's simulated repository for CVE-2026-1337.
2. Read the repository's README.
3. Identify the script named as demonstrating the vulnerability.
4. Do not execute untrusted code just because it is hosted on GitHub.



Answer recorded from a current-version walkthrough: exploit.py

Learning point: Repositories can contain useful proof-of-concept code, but code may be incomplete, unsafe, or malicious. Inspect its source and provenance first and only test in an authorized, isolated environment.

Answer Summary

Task	Question area	Answer to verify
2	Domain for 185.243.115.47	tryhackme.thm
3	Vendors flagging invoice_payment.exe	52
4	CVSS classification for the simulated CVE	10 / Critical
5	Netcat example command	nc host.example.com 42
6	Repository demonstration script	exploit.py

These values come from a current-version third-party walkthrough and should be checked against the live TryHackMe simulation, since room content and accepted answers can change.

3. Key Concepts Learned

- **OSINT:** Gathering and evaluating information from publicly available sources.
- **Shodan:** Searches indexed information about internet-connected devices and exposed services.
- **VirusTotal-style analysis:** Aggregates security-vendor assessments to support file or URL triage.
- **CVE:** A standardized identifier for a publicly documented vulnerability.

- **CVSS:** A scoring framework for communicating vulnerability severity.
- **Linux manual pages:** Local reference documentation accessible with commands such as man nc.
- **GitHub research:** Can reveal source code and proof-of-concept demonstrations, but repositories must be assessed before code is trusted or executed.

